UNCOMMON SCHOOLS

CHANGE HISTORY

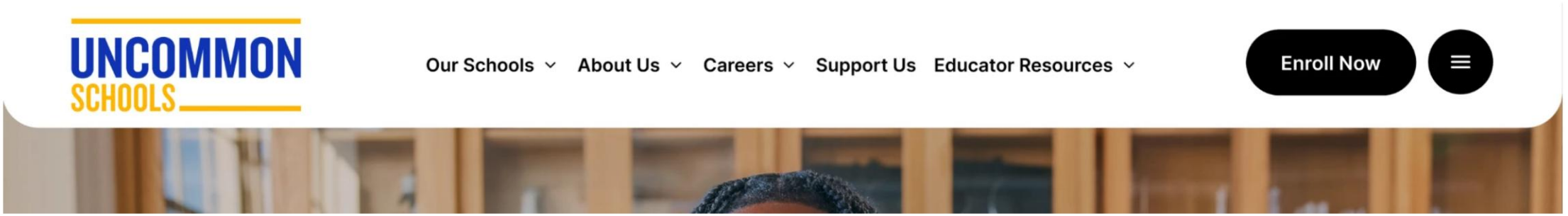
Website Redesign Homepage Design Guidelines

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

30 YEARS OF IMPACT

Header

1. **Taller header.** Slightly taller than the wireframe, giving the logo and the navigation more room.
2. **Larger logo.** The Uncommon Schools logo is larger for a stronger brand presence at the top of the page.
3. **Rounded bottom corners.** The header sits as a shape over the hero image.

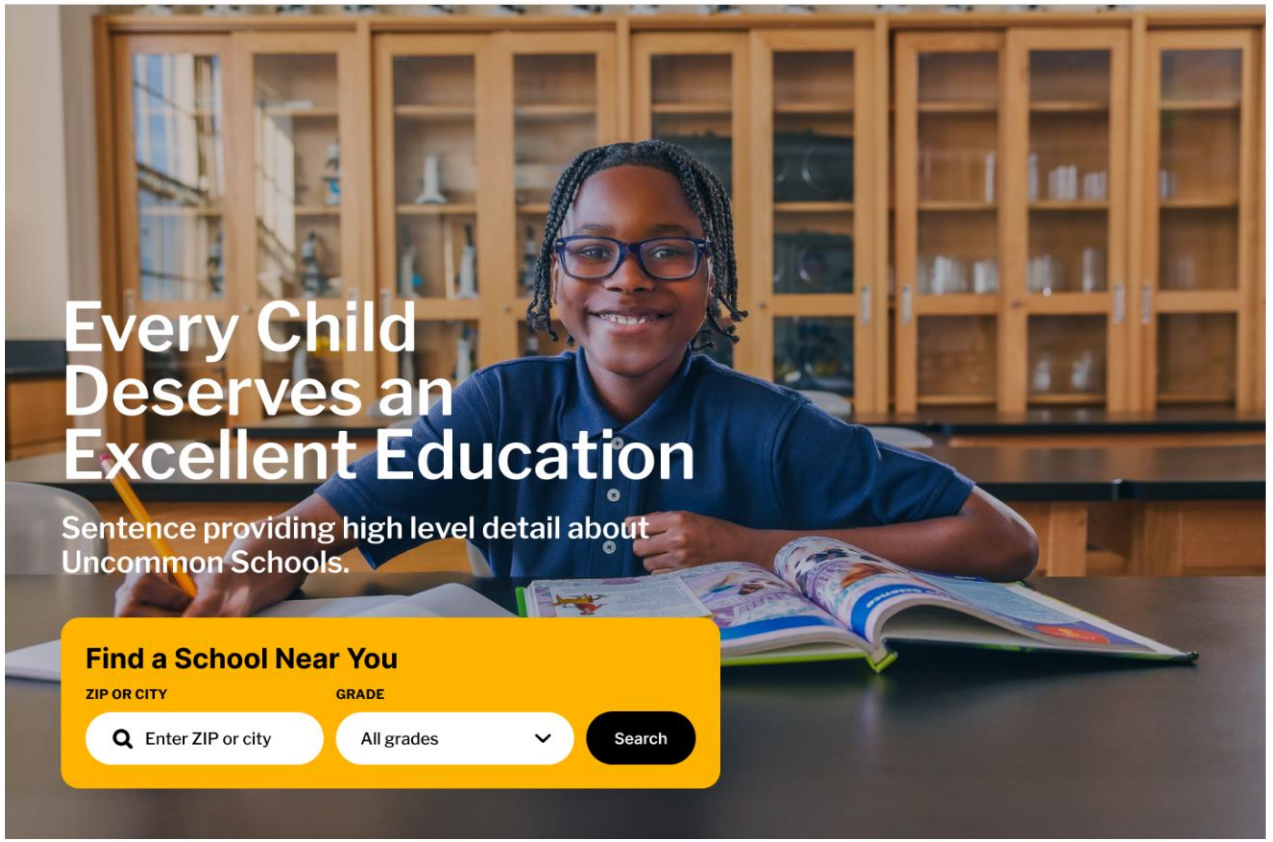


Header over the hero photo

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Hero

1. **Dark tint on the photo.** The hero photo carries a dark tint so the white headline stays readable over any image.
2. **Calmer type.** The headline and supporting text are set smaller than in the wireframe, so the photo carries more of the weight.
3. **Find a School stays in the hero.** Locked up with the headline and supporting text, so the first action a family needs is visible on arrival.

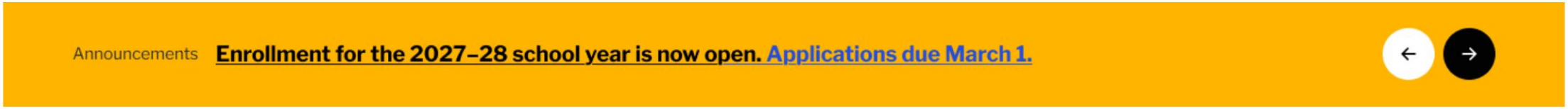


Homepage hero

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Announcement bar

1. **Yellow bar.** Matches the Find a School card, so announcements are noticed at a glance.
2. **Arrows cycle the announcements.** Several announcements, shown one at a time.

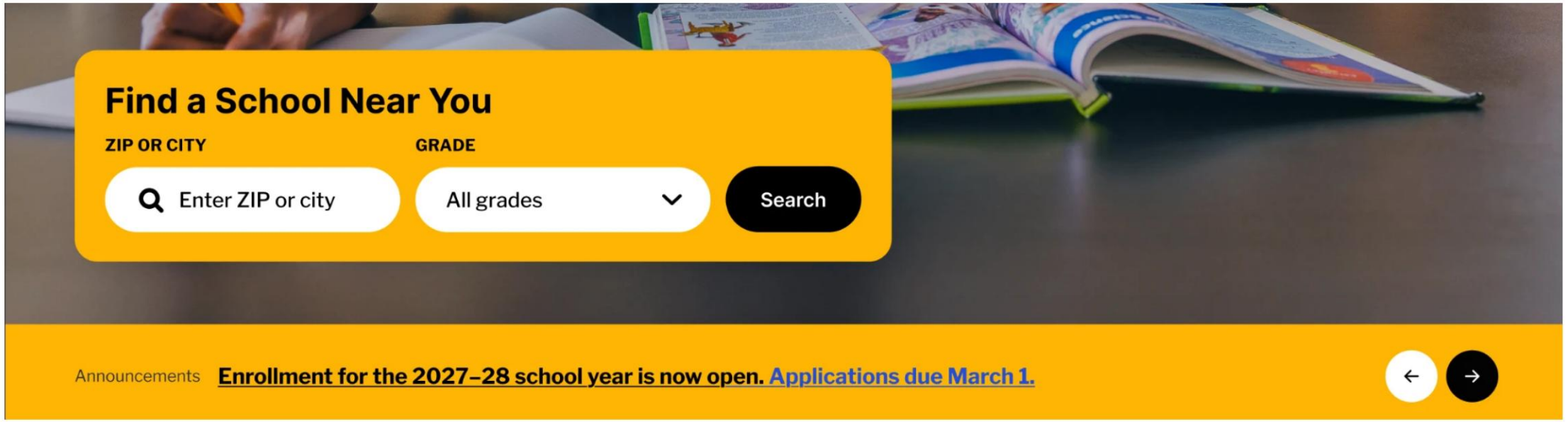


Announcement bar under the hero

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Feature cards

1. **Yellow background, white selectors, black button.** Feature cards like the Find a School card use this combination.
2. **Yellow over blue.** Yellow adds vibrancy and energy where we want the eye to go.



Find a School card in the hero

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Headline colours

1. **Two colour pairs.** White and yellow on dark backgrounds. Black and blue on light backgrounds.
2. **The second colour highlights the key words.** Yellow on dark sections, blue on light sections.
3. **Supporting text.** White on dark backgrounds, black on light backgrounds.



Dark background: white and yellow



Light background: black and blue

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Headline type

1. **Section headlines: Knockout 49 Liteweight.**
2. **Section supporting text: Libre Franklin Medium.**
3. **No ellipsis in headlines.** The example on the right shows the one thing not to copy.

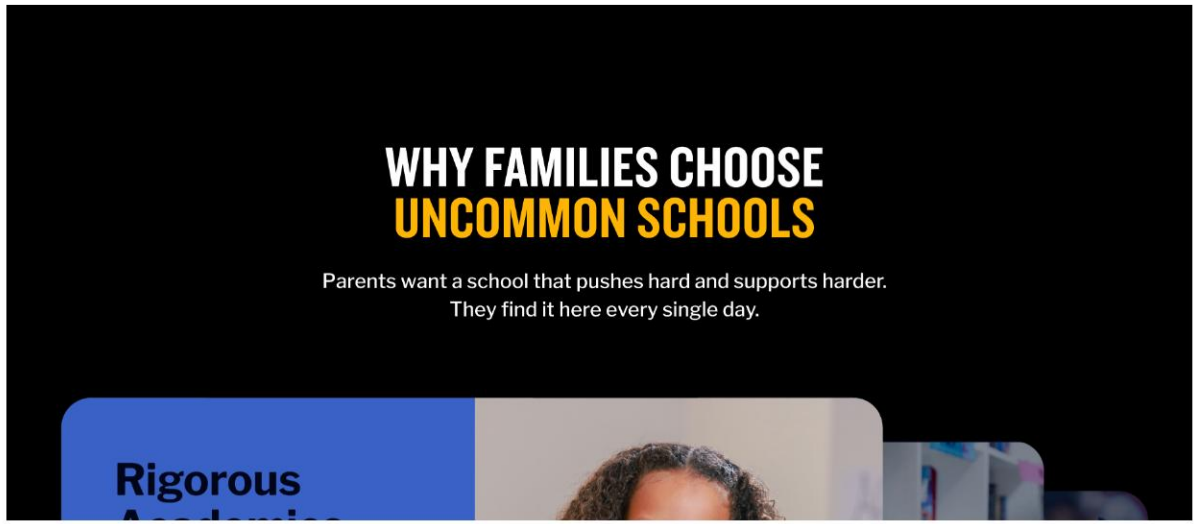
UNCOMMON SCHOOLS ARE...

Knockout 49 Liteweight. The ellipsis is not used.

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Colour

1. **Black, never dark navy.** Whenever a dark colour is needed, use black.
2. **Secondary colours as accents.** Where possible, use secondary colours from the brand guidelines to add a touch of variation, never in a significant way.



Black section background

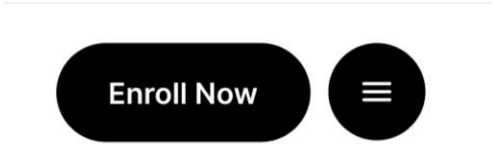


Secondary colours as accents in the media wall

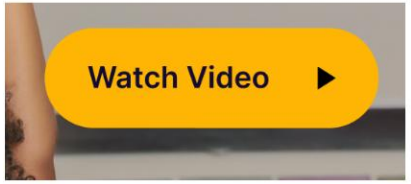
© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Buttons

1. **Calls to action are pills.** Always pill-shaped and one height, so they read as one family across the page.
2. **Secondary calls to action are circles.** The arrow buttons on cards and carousels.
3. **Outlined family.** The footer buttons, the menu button and the carousel next button use outlines, drawn thicker so they read at a glance.



Primary: black pill and menu circle



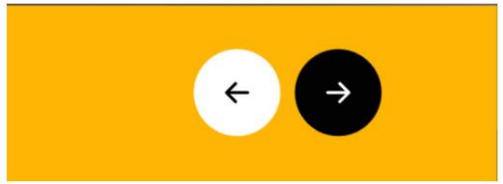
Yellow pill with icon



Yellow pill



Secondary: outlined circle

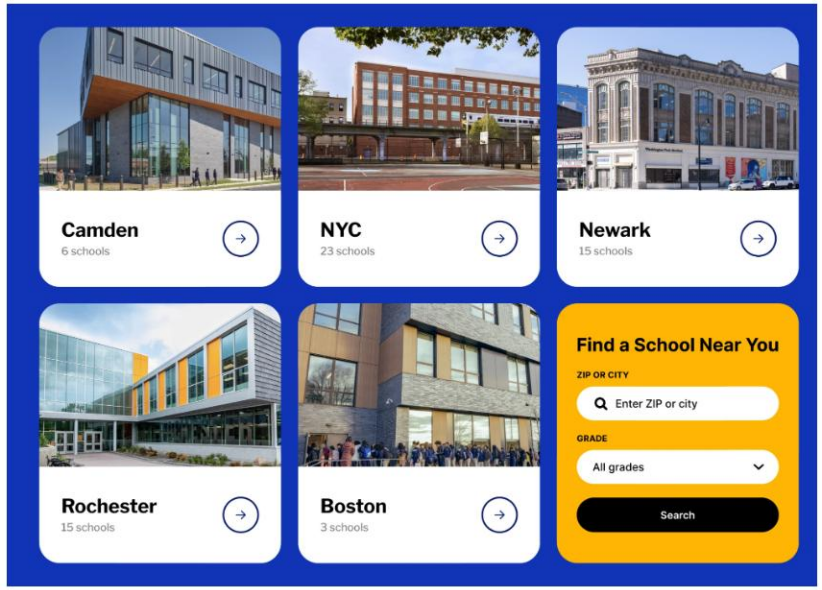


Secondary: previous and next

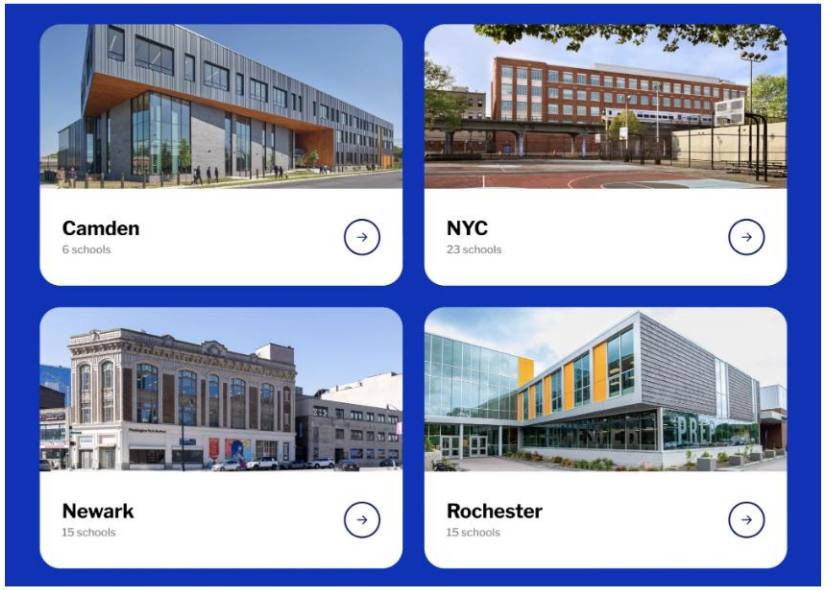
© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Regional cards

1. **Columns of three or two.** Regional cards are displayed in either.
2. **Find a School pairs with the group.** The card sits with the regional cards, as the sixth card in a grid of three.
3. **Always the circle arrow.** Regional cards always use the circle secondary call to action.
4. **Each card holds** a school exterior photo, the region name, the number of schools and the arrow.



Three columns, Find a School as the sixth card

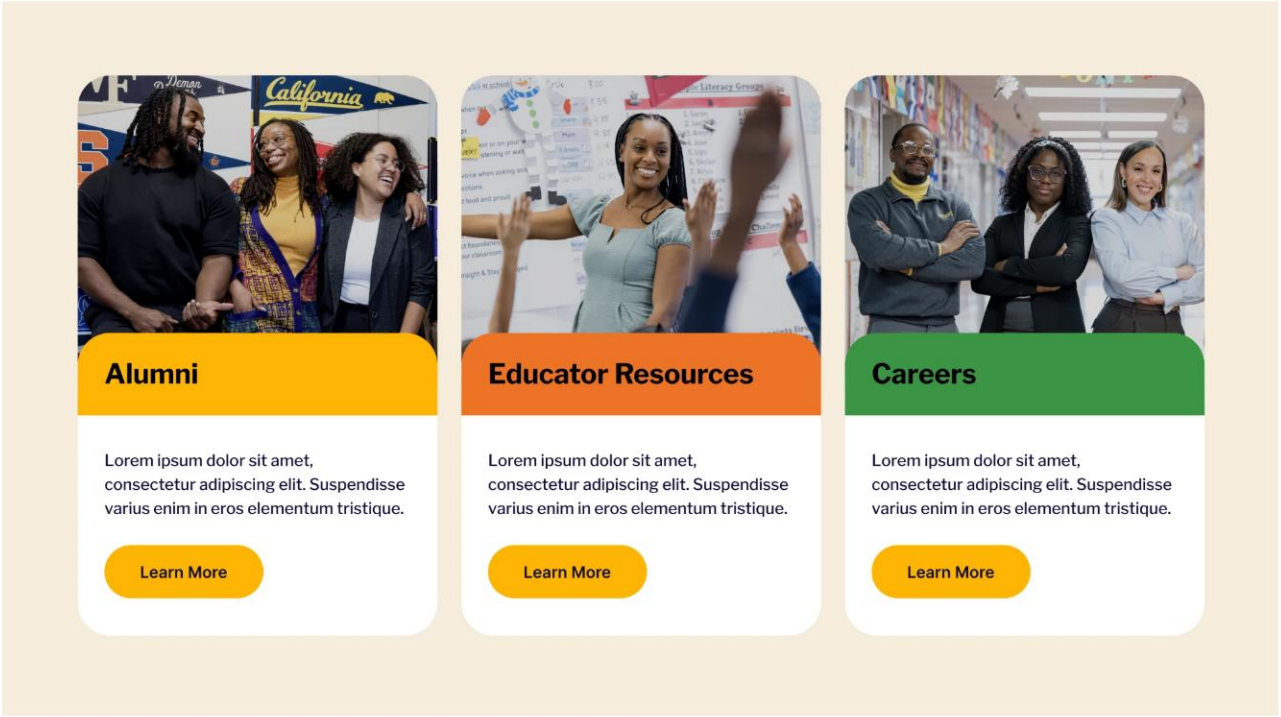


Two columns

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Content cards

1. **Photography, not generic icons.** Icons feel generic and add no emotion or connection to a card.
2. **Colourful accent shapes and designs** carry the card instead, like the coloured title bands.

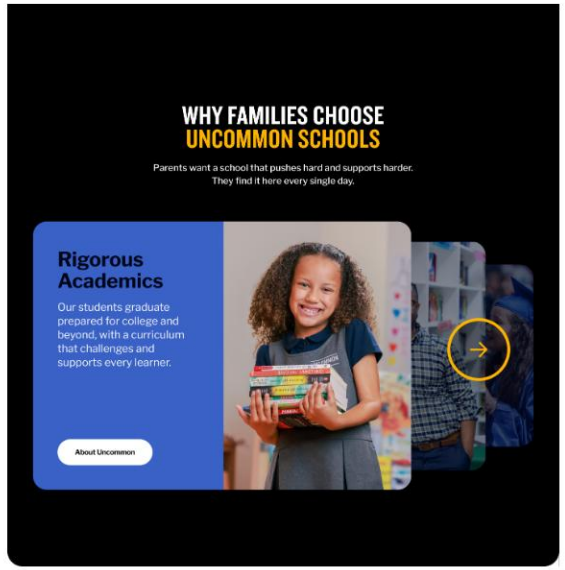


Your Connection cards

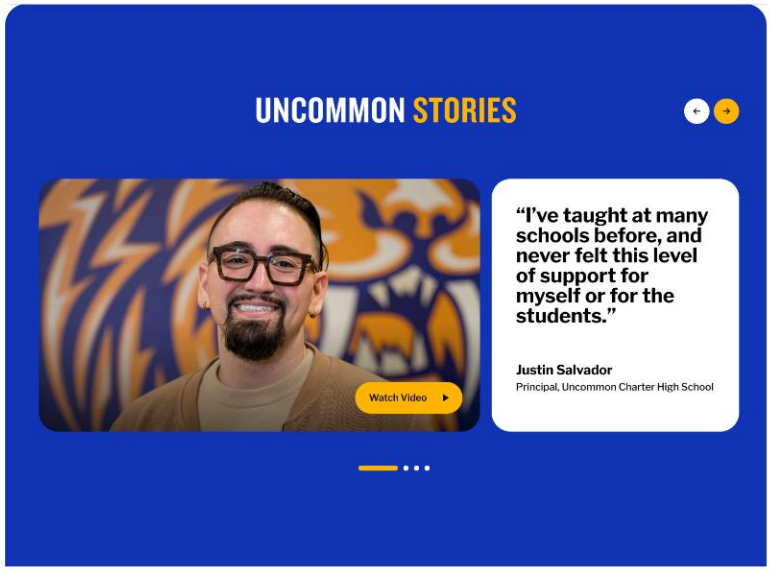
© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Carousels

1. **Why Families is a slide carousel, not an accordion.** Each pillar is one slide: a blue card with the title, copy and button, paired with a photo. The next slides peek out behind the active one. The three pillars are Rigorous Academics, A Community That Knows Your Child, and Private-School Quality, Tuition-Free.
2. **Uncommon Stories is a carousel of stories.** Arrows and dots move between them. The quote card names the person and their role.
3. **The next button is the outlined circle** of the card arrows, not a solid button with a Next label.



Why Families Choose Uncommon Schools



Uncommon Stories

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Photo and video

1. **Media wall.** The mission statement is a grid of photo tiles with openings for single-word brand descriptors. Each tile cycles through two or three images; each descriptor can cycle through a set of words.

2. **Video.** The thumbnail beside Joyful opens a lightbox that plays the brand video. The story card plays a short looping clip until Watch Video is pressed, which opens the full video.



Media wall

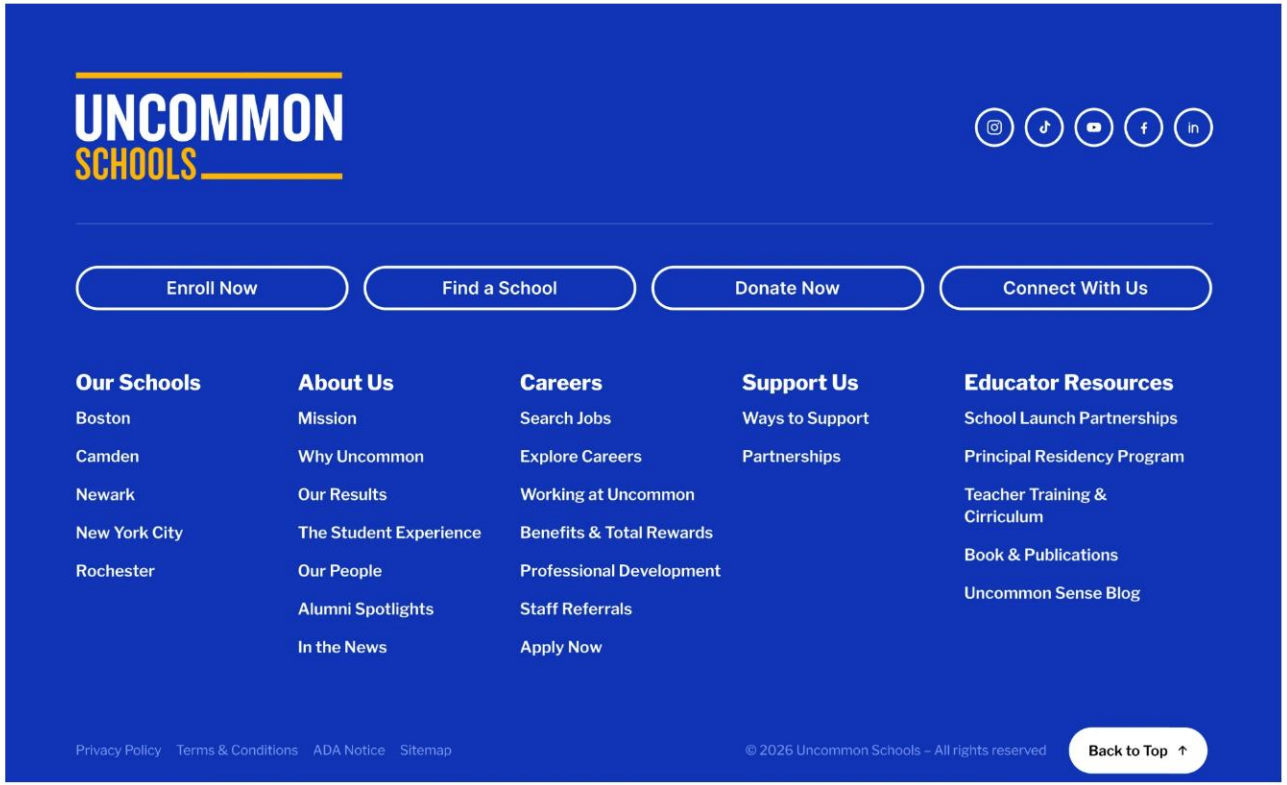


Video card

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.

Footer

1. **The footer of choice.** Brand blue, logo top left, social icons top right, four buttons, five link columns, legal links and Back to Top along the bottom.
2. **Four outlined buttons.** White stroke outlines, never filled or coloured.
3. **Five columns.** This column orientation is the choice from the variations provided.



Footer

© 2026–27 Uncommon Schools, Inc. All rights reserved.